	SELECTION, EVALUATION AND MONITORING OF CONTRACTOR/SUBCONTRACTORS	
	Document no: ASMF-6.2	
Compiled by:	**Sifiso Nyambi - Laboratory Manager**	
Approved by:	**Nonhlanhla Msibi - Operations Manager**	

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Effective date	Rev status	Next review date
02/2026	01	02/2029

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Purpose

To define the procedure for selecting, evaluating, approving, and monitoring contractor/subcontractors involved in any part of Azuresky (Pty) Ltd resource requirements of ISO/IEC 17043:2023 clause 6.4 ISO/IEC 17034:2016 Clause 6.2 and ISO/IEC 17025:2017 clause 6.6.

Application

This procedure applies to all subcontracted tasks including sampling, processing, handling, testing (homogeneity/stability), characterization, storage, and distribution of reference materials.

Responsibilities

Operations Manager: Technical evaluation and approvals of contractor/subcontractor capabilities

Laboratory Manager: Day to day supervision and performance monitoring of contractor/subcontractors

Laboratory supervisor: Supervision of dispatching of subcontracted work

Procedure

Communication to Contractor/subcontractors

Azuresky shall communicate its requirements to external providers for:

- The products and services to be provided?
- The acceptance criteria?
- Competence, including any required qualification of the organization or personnel involved?
- Activities that the Azuresky (Pty) Ltd or its customers intend to perform at the external provider's premises?
- Is the Azuresky (Pty) Ltd responsible to the participants or customers for the externally provided products and services?

Identification of Contractor/subcontractors and initial screening

The initial step when subcontracting work is to identify contractor/subcontractors after careful evaluation of tasks that require subcontracting. The organization is supposed to have the following information available to begin screening contractor/subcontractors:

- Scope of accreditation

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- Accreditation status (accredited)-where applicable
- Competence (where accreditation status is not applicable)
- Past relevant experience
- Recent participation in proficiency schemes – where applicable

Evaluation and selection of contractor/subcontractors

The next step is the use of form ASMF6.2 Checklist to assess: technical competence, compliance with the relevant ISO standards (ISO 17034, ISO 33405 and ISO 17025), document control and quality system. For critical tasks, ensure the contractor/subcontractor is ISO/IEC 17025 accredited (where applicable).

Approval and contracting

Contracts to initiate subcontracting work should include the following to ensure compliance:

- Detailed scope of accreditation
- Quality requirements
- Access to data and facilities for audit
- Signed confidentiality agreements

Performance Monitoring

A contractor performance evaluation is a process by which Azuresky assess the skills, work efficiency, and reliability of the contractor/subcontractor. This can be done through the inclusion of technical scrutinizing of submitted data, onsite audits and non-conformity reports. This assessment is to be performed periodically (as defined by the risk assessment) throughout the course of service delivery in order to provide feedback on progress being made as well as identify areas that could use improvement. Furthermore, excessive slippage situations such as missed deadlines shall be flagged earlier than expected before things get out of hand allowing corrective measures to be taken more quickly! An early warning sheet ASMF 6.2 B is to be used to record such.

Action on Poor Contractor or Subcontractor Performance

Where the annual evaluation or ongoing monitoring identifies unsatisfactory performance of a contractor or subcontractor, the Early Warning Notification Form (ASMF 6.2B) shall be issued.

ASMF 6.2B is used to formally notify the contractor/subcontractor of:

- Identified performance deficiencies.
- Potential risks to service delivery or quality of results.

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- Required corrective actions and response timeframes.

The contractor/subcontractor is required to submit a written response detailing corrective actions to be taken to address the identified issues.

Continued unsatisfactory performance after issue of an Early Warning Notification may result in:

- Suspension of use of the contractor/subcontractor; or
- Removal from the approved contractor/subcontractor list.

Records of issued Early Warning Notifications and responses received are retained as evidence of performance monitoring and control.

Re-evaluation

Monitoring of Supplier and Service Provider Performance

The listed evaluation criteria are used not only for initial approval but also for ongoing performance monitoring of contractors and subcontractors.

Performance is reviewed annually using ASMF 6.2C (Contractor/Subcontractor Evaluation Checklist) based on the following:

- **Experience or similar subcontracted work:**
  Verified through satisfactory completion of previous work orders and technical acceptability of results provided.
- **Established operating procedures:**
  Assessed through review of submitted procedures and consistency of service delivery.
- **Relevant accreditation:**
  Monitored by confirming validity and scope of accreditation certificates where applicable.
- **Participation in relevant proficiency testing (PT) schemes:**
  Evaluated by reviewing PT performance summaries where applicable to outsourced activities.
- **History of responsive communication:**
  Monitored through response times, resolution of queries, and cooperation during service delivery.
- **Allows audits:**
  Evaluated through willingness to permit audits or provide objective evidence of compliance when requested.

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These criteria provide objective evidence of the continued ability of the supplier or service provider to meet technical and quality requirements and therefore serve as performance monitoring indicators.

Records

The following records are to be presented when closing selection of contractor/subcontractors:

- Approved contractor/subcontractor register (ASMF6.2-Register)
- Evaluation Checklist
- Audit Reports (PT participation)
- Contracts and Agreements
- Communication logs

Revision

Revision no	Content changed	Reason for revision
01	No content changed but rather an addition	The procedure did not explain how the evaluation criteria will be used to monitor suppliers and services providers.
01	No content changed but rather an addition	Explanation on the use of early warning sheet ASMF 6.2.B

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02/2026	01	02/2029